

FRONTEND DEVELOPMENT → REACT → PORTFOLIO WEBSITE → JOB-SEEKER TRACK

Ship a hiring-ready *React portfolio*, stage by stage.

A complete, end-to-end build plan — not a checklist — for a student or job-seeker turning existing projects into a live React portfolio that survives recruiter scrutiny. Every stage below has objectives, tasks, the right AI tools, prompts you can copy, and the mistakes to avoid.

7	18–26h	12+	1
STAGES	TOTAL EFFORT	AI TOOLS MAPPED	DEPLOYED SITE

01

Planning & Positioning

 2–3 hrs

Decide who this portfolio is for and what single claim it has to prove before any code is written.

OBJECTIVES

- Define one-sentence positioning (role + strength)
- Identify target roles/companies to reverse-engineer expectations
- Set scope: how many projects, what pages, what NOT to include

TASKS

- Audit all past projects and school work in a spreadsheet
- Shortlist 8–10 target job postings, note repeated required skills
- Write a 1-sentence positioning statement and test it on 2 people

STAGE FLOW



BEST AI TOOLS

TOOL	WHY IT'S RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE
Claude Recommended	Best for structured reasoning — turning a messy project list + job posting text into a scoped plan and gap analysis.	ChatGPT
Teal / Careerflow	Aggregates job postings and extracts common required skills automatically.	Manual spreadsheet + Claude
Notion AI	Good for turning brainstorm notes into a structured project-audit table.	Google Sheets + Claude

PROMPT EXAMPLES

I'm a [year] student targeting [role, e.g. junior frontend developer] roles. Here are my projects: [list]. Here are 6 job postings I'm targeting: [paste]. Identify the 3 skills that appear most often, then tell me which 3-4 of my projects best prove those skills.

[Copy](#)

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Anchor positioning in evidence you actually have, not aspirational skills
- ✓ Write the sentence before touching design — it should fit on the hero

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ Trying to appeal to every possible role at once
- ✗ Skipping job-posting research and guessing what recruiters want

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

1-sentence positioning statement

Shortlist of 3-4 projects to feature

Skill-gap list for messaging

YOUR NOTES

target Role: Frontend React Developer
Target Companies: Product-based companies
Selected Skills: React, JavaScript, Responsive Design
Portfolio Goal: Build a recruiter-ready portfolio.



02

Project Curation

🕒 2–4 hrs

Turn raw repos into case-study-ready material: what problem each project solves and what proof it offers.

OBJECTIVES

- Select final 3–4 projects
- Extract a clear problem/approach/result narrative per project
- Gather or generate clean visuals (screenshots, GIFs) for each

TASKS

- Write a 3-line summary per project: problem, your role, outcome
- Clean up each repo's README for public viewing
- Capture screenshots/screen recordings at consistent resolution

STAGE FLOW



BEST AI TOOLS

TOOL	WHY IT'S RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE
Claude Recommended	Turns rough commit history or README notes into a tight, recruiter-readable case study without inflating claims.	ChatGPT
CleanShot X / Screen Studio	Produces polished, consistent screen recordings/GIFs for project demos.	Loom + native screenshot tool
GitHub Copilot	Helps quickly clean up code comments/README structure before it's shown publicly.	Claude Code

PROMPT EXAMPLES

Here is my project README and file structure: [paste]. Write a 3-part case study (Problem, Approach, Result) in under 150 words, written for a recruiter with 20 seconds of attention, no jargon unless it's a named technology.

Copy

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Show your specific contribution clearly if it was a team project
- ✓ Prefer 3 strong, finished projects over 6 half-finished ones

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ Featuring tutorial clones with no personal modification
- ✗ Using inconsistent screenshot sizes/browsers across projects

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

3-4 finalized project write-ups

Cleaned screenshots/GIFs per project

Public-ready GitHub repos

YOUR NOTES

- task manager
- Movie Search App

Need better screenshots and updated README files.



03

UX & Visual Design

 3–5 hrs

Decide the structure and visual language before opening a code editor.

OBJECTIVES

- Wireframe page structure (hero, projects, about, contact)
- Choose a type + color system
- Define responsive behavior for mobile

TASKS

- Sketch low-fidelity wireframes for desktop and mobile
- Pick 2 fonts and a 4–5 color palette
- Decide on layout: single-page scroll vs multi-page

STAGE FLOW



BEST AI TOOLS

TOOL	WHY IT'S RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE
Figma (+ Figma AI) Recommended	Industry-standard for wireframing and component-level design before code; AI features speed up layout variations.	Excalidraw
Claude	Good for reasoning through information architecture — what order sections should appear in, what a recruiter reads first.	ChatGPT
Coolors / Realtime Colors	Fast palette generation and live-preview against real UI, not swatches alone.	Adobe Color

PROMPT EXAMPLES

I'm designing a one-page portfolio for a frontend job seeker. Sections under consideration: hero, featured projects, about, skills, contact. In what order should these appear to hold a recruiter's attention, and what should each section's single job be?

Copy

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Design mobile-first; most recruiter clicks happen on desktop but assume both
- ✓ Limit yourself to 2 typefaces and one accent color

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ Copying a trendy dark-glassmorphism template with no relation to your work
- ✗ Designing before deciding what content exists

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

Low-fi wireframe (desktop + mobile)

Color and type system

Section order finalized

YOUR NOTES

Theme: Light
Accent Color: Blue
Fonts: Poppins + Inter
Sections: Hero, About, Skills, Projects, Contact



◆ Decision Tree: What should you build first?

Answer honestly — this decides where to spend your next hour.

Do you already have 3+ finished projects worth showing?

Yes, they're solid

Sort of, they're rough

No, not really

04

React Build

 6–9 hrs

Build the app in components, from scaffold to functioning pages.

OBJECTIVES

- Scaffold project with Vite + React
- Build reusable components (Nav, ProjectCard, Hero, Footer)
- Wire up routing/sections and responsive layout

TASKS

- Initialize project, install Tailwind or CSS Modules
- Build component tree matching the wireframe
- Implement responsive breakpoints and basic animations

STAGE FLOW



BEST AI TOOLS

TOOL	WHY IT'S RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE
Claude Code Recommended	Handles multi-file React scaffolding, component wiring, and debugging directly in your project — best for actual implementation, not just snippets.	GitHub Copilot
v0 by Vercel	Generates React + Tailwind component drafts from a text/image prompt fast, good for a first-pass Hero or ProjectCard.	Claude in browser
GitHub Copilot	Strong for in-editor autocomplete once component structure already exists.	Cursor

PROMPT EXAMPLES

Scaffold a Vite + React + Tailwind portfolio project with components: Hero, ProjectCard, ProjectGrid, About, ContactFooter. Hero takes a name, tagline, and CTA. ProjectCard takes

Copy

title, description, tags[], image, liveUrl, repoUrl. Keep components typed with PropTypes or TS, no external UI library.

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Componentize early: Hero, ProjectCard, Nav, Footer as separate files
- ✓ Commit after each working component, not at the end

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ Building one giant App.jsx with everything inline
- ✗ Adding a UI kit/animation library before the layout itself works

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

Working React app with all sections

Reusable component library

Responsive layout at 3 breakpoints

YOUR NOTES

Framework: React + Vite
Styling: Tailwind CSS
Components: Navbar, Hero, Projects, About, Contact, Footer
Responsive: Mobile, Tablet, Desktop



05

Content & Copy

 2-3 hrs

Fill the built shell with copy that reads like proof, not a resume restated.

OBJECTIVES

- Write hero headline and subline
- Write per-project case study copy
- Write an About section that supports the positioning from Stage 1

TASKS

- Draft and test 3 hero headline options
- Insert finalized project case studies from Stage 2
- Write About section and skills list, keep it under 150 words

STAGE FLOW



BEST AI TOOLS

TOOL	WHY IT'S RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE
Claude Recommended	Best for iterative copy tightening — cutting resume-speak, keeping claims honest, matching tone to positioning statement.	ChatGPT
Hemingway Editor	Flags overly complex sentences so copy stays skimmable.	Grammarly
Grammarly	Catches grammar/tone issues across the final pass.	ProWritingAid

PROMPT EXAMPLES

Rewrite this About section so it supports this positioning statement: [positioning]. Cut anything that sounds like a resume bullet. Keep it under 120 words, second-person confident tone, no buzzwords like 'passionate' or 'detail-oriented'.

[Copy](#)

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Lead each project with the outcome, not the tech stack
- ✓ Keep total on-page word count low — this is a skim medium

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ Copy-pasting resume bullet points directly onto the page
- ✗ Burying the live demo/repo links below the fold

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

Finalized hero, about, and project copy

Skills list matched to Stage 1 gap analysis

YOUR NOTES

Hero Title: Frontend React Developer
About: Building responsive and user-friendly web applications.
CTA: View Projects



06 Polish & Optimize

2-3 hrs

Make the site fast, accessible, and free of the small mistakes that undercut credibility.

OBJECTIVES

- Pass Lighthouse performance/accessibility checks
- Add responsive images and lazy loading
- Test keyboard navigation and color contrast

TASKS

- Run Lighthouse audit, fix flagged issues
- Compress and lazy-load project images
- Tab through the whole site to check focus states

STAGE FLOW



BEST AI TOOLS

TOOL	WHY IT'S RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE
Chrome Lighthouse / PageSpeed Insights Recommended	Free, direct performance/accessibility/SEO score with specific fixes — the standard pre-launch check.	WebPageTest
Claude Code	Good for implementing specific fixes Lighthouse flags (alt text, contrast, lazy loading) directly in code.	GitHub Copilot
axe DevTools	Deeper accessibility scan than Lighthouse alone, catches ARIA issues.	WAVE

PROMPT EXAMPLES

```
Here are my Lighthouse results: [paste scores/issues]. For each issue, tell me the specific
```

Copy

code change needed in a React + Tailwind project, ordered by impact on score.

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Target Lighthouse scores above 90 on performance and accessibility
- ✓ Test on an actual phone, not just devtools responsive mode

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ Shipping unoptimized full-resolution screenshots
- ✗ Ignoring keyboard-only navigation entirely

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

- Lighthouse scores 90+ across categories
- Optimized image assets
- Verified keyboard/contrast accessibility

YOUR NOTES

- Optimize images
- Improve Accessibility
- SEO Meta Tags
- Test Responsive Design



07

Deploy & Promote

🕒 1-2 hrs

Ship it live and put the link everywhere a recruiter will look.

OBJECTIVES

- Deploy to a fast, free host with a custom domain
- Add the link to resume, LinkedIn, GitHub profile, and applications
- Set up basic analytics to see if it's being viewed

TASKS

- Connect repo to Vercel/Netlify, verify production build
- Point a custom domain or clean subdomain at it
- Add link to resume header, LinkedIn 'Featured', GitHub bio

STAGE FLOW



BEST AI TOOLS

TOOL	WHY IT'S RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE
Vercel Recommended	Zero-config deploys for Vite/React projects, free tier, automatic previews on every push.	Netlify
Plausible / Simple Analytics	Lightweight, privacy-friendly view counts without a heavy tracking script.	Google Analytics
Claude	Helps draft the LinkedIn post and application blurb announcing the portfolio.	ChatGPT

PROMPT EXAMPLES

Write a short LinkedIn post announcing my new portfolio at [url]. I'm a [role] job seeker featuring [project names]. Keep it under 80 words, no hashtag spam, one clear call to action.

Copy

BEST PRACTICES

- ✓ Use a short, memorable custom domain if possible (firstlast.dev)
- ✓ Re-check the live production build, not just local dev, before sharing

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ Sharing the localhost/dev version link by mistake in an application
- ✗ Forgetting to update the portfolio link in old applications already sent

EXPECTED OUTPUTS

Live deployed portfolio URL

Updated resume/LinkedIn/GitHub with link

Basic analytics tracking enabled

YOUR NOTES

Hosting: Vercel
Repository: GitHub
Analytics: Google Analytics
Share on LinkedIn and Resume



Workflow Summary

This track takes a job-seeker from an unfocused list of school/side projects to a deployed, recruiter-ready React portfolio. The path: define your one-sentence positioning → pick and prune 3–4 projects that prove it → wireframe and design the UX → build the React app in components → write copy that reads like a case study, not a resume → optimize performance and accessibility → deploy and attach the link everywhere you apply. Total realistic effort is 18–26 hours across 1–2 weeks for someone with basic React familiarity.

Recommended AI Stack

PLANNING

Claude

DESIGN

Figma + Figma AI

BUILD

Claude Code

Structured reasoning across job postings + project audits.

Wireframing and layout variations pre-code.

Multi-file React implementation and debugging.

COPYWRITING

Claude

Turns technical notes into recruiter-readable case studies.

QA

Lighthouse

Performance, accessibility, SEO scoring pre-launch.

HOSTING

Vercel

Zero-config deploys with previews on every push.

LEARNING RESOURCES

- React official docs — [react.dev](https://react.dev/learn) "Learn" section
- Josh Comeau's CSS & React blog
- web.dev — performance & accessibility guides
- Frontend Mentor — real design briefs to practice
- Refactoring UI (book) — fast design instincts

COMMUNITIES

- r/reactjs, r/frontend, r/cscareerquestions
- Frontend Mentor Discord / Slack
- Dev.to and Hashnode portfolio threads
- Local/university career center portfolio reviews
- LinkedIn [#buildinpublic](#) threads for feedback

SEARCH KEYWORDS

react portfolio template

vite react deploy vercel

portfolio case study structure

lighthouse performance audit

a11y react checklist

framer motion scroll reveal

Additional AI Prompts

Review my portfolio's "About" section for tone. I want it to sound confident but not arrogant, written for a hiring manager skimming in 20 seconds. Here's my draft: [paste]

Copy

Generate 5 alt hero headlines for a frontend developer portfolio, each under 8 words, lead with outcome not job title.

Copy

Here is my project's README: [paste]. Turn it into a 3-paragraph case study: problem, approach, result, written for a non-technical recruiter.

Copy

Future Automation Opportunities

- Auto-sync GitHub repo stats (stars, last commit) into portfolio via GitHub API + scheduled build
- AI-generated project screenshots/GIFs from a headless browser script on each deploy

- Automated Lighthouse CI check on every push, blocking deploy if score drops below threshold
- Chatbot on the portfolio itself, trained on your resume, to answer recruiter questions live
- Auto-tailored one-pager PDF export generated per job application from portfolio content

AI WORKFLOW ARCHITECT • Progress and notes are saved locally in your browser • Nothing is uploaded anywhere